

Peer Response to Initial Post for [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Monday, 27 October 2025, 10:51 PM

by [Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi](#) - Friday, 31 October 2025, 8:03 PM

Hi Abdulrahman,

The case of Dark Patterns you have analysed is informative and successfully relates the ACM and BCS codes to the ethical aspects of dishonest design. I concur with your argument that such manipulative design decision-making is in contravention of the major principles of the ACM, especially the one that advocates the cause of the populace (1.1) and the one that avoids harm (1.2). The designers manipulate user autonomy and destroy trust, which is essential in honesty and fairness (1.3), by guiding users to more expensive or inadvertent choices.

The way you have connected this to the BCS Code of Conduct (2022) and its focus on serving the interests of the public and being upright is also something that I like. The two codes are categorical about deceptive manipulation. Ethically, this type of practice is more of an exploitation rather than an innovation, and, as you mentioned, the practice may be violating the principles of fairness and transparency of the UK GDPR (MacLure, MacLure, Levy, and Dearing, 2022).

Another aspect that should be mentioned is that dark patterns not only harm the consumer but also destroy the professional reputation of computing practitioners. ACM Principle 3.3 states that professionals must guarantee ethical design systems and reduce the possible harm before their implementation (Carey, 2018). Not only is transparent, user-centred design a legal requirement, but it is also a consumer-facing aspect that is imperative according to the need to maintain trust among the population in the use of technology.

Very good post on the convergence of ethics, law and design integrity.

References

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MacLure, K., MacLure, A., Levy, S. and Dearing, W., 2022. Characterising the health and social care segment of the BCS (The Chartered Institute for IT) membership and their continuing professional development needs. *BMJ Health & Care Informatics*, 29(1), p.e100504.

Information Commissioner's Office (2023) A guide to the data protection principles (UK GDPR, Article 5). Available at: <https://ico.org.uk> (Accessed: 1 November 2025).

Peer Response to Initial Post for [Mustafa Hussein](#) - Monday, 27 October 2025, 9:22 PM
by [Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi](#) - Friday, 31 October 2025, 8:05 PM

Hi Mustafa,

Your analysis of the case study on Abusive Workplace Behaviour has been insightful and well put. I fully concur with your interpretation that this behaviour not only goes against the provisions of the ACM Code of Ethics (2018) but also the central tenets of professional respect and fairness provided in the BCS Code of Conduct (2021). Especially significant to my mind is your argument that avoiding harm (ACM Principle 1.2) applies not only to physical health but also to emotions and psychological wellbeing, because ethical computing has to safeguard not only systems but people.

Your association with the Equality Act 2010 reinforces your argument since it demonstrates that unethical behaviour frequently intersects with the violation of the law. Constant intimidation does make one consider that it is harassment, and this creates an unhealthy work environment that harms individuals and the image of the profession (Fell, and Dyban, 2017). In addition, computing professionals are supposed to treat people well and provide supportive leadership as stipulated in the 3.1 principle of ACM. The elderly employee in this scenario obviously did not fulfil this obligation well (Gotterbarn, Don, et al. 2017).

I also like how you have concentrated on organisational culture. The essential role of trust and partnership in computing teams is facilitated by the encouragement of respectful communication and by promoting inclusion. Good leadership ought not merely to avoid causing harm, but must create a culture of decency and honour.

Your post connects ethical, legal, and professional views in a good way.

References

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